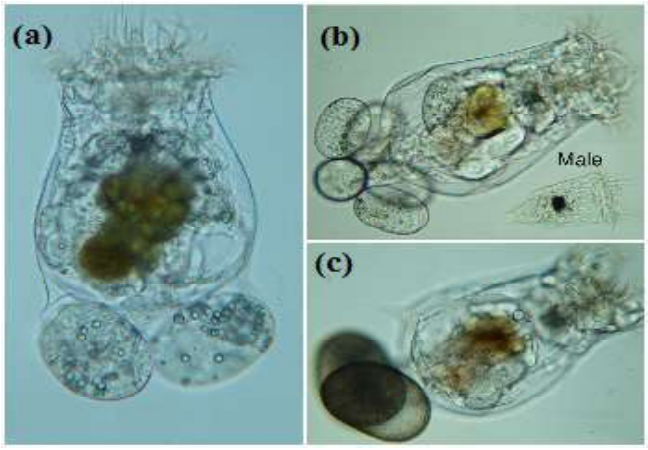


Fig. 2: Life-cycle stages of *Brachionus calyciflorus*. (a) Female carrying two diploid eggs developing parthenogenetically into females. (b) Female carrying five haploid eggs developing parthenogenetically into haploid males, and one hatched male. (c) Fertilised female carrying two encysted diapausing embryos or resting eggs.

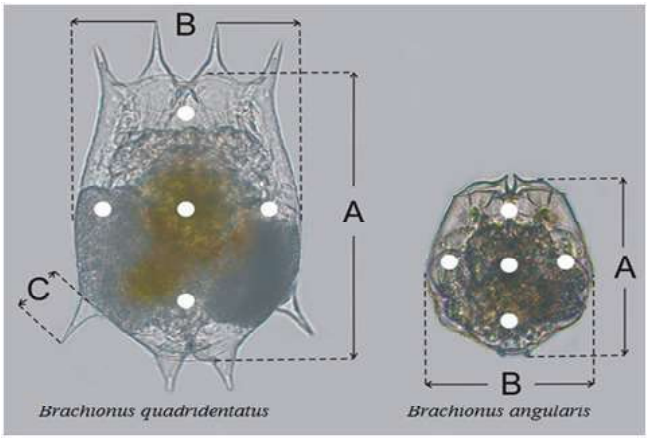


Fig. 3: Biometric characters of *Brachionus* species (A) body length; (B) body width; (C) length of posterolateral spine

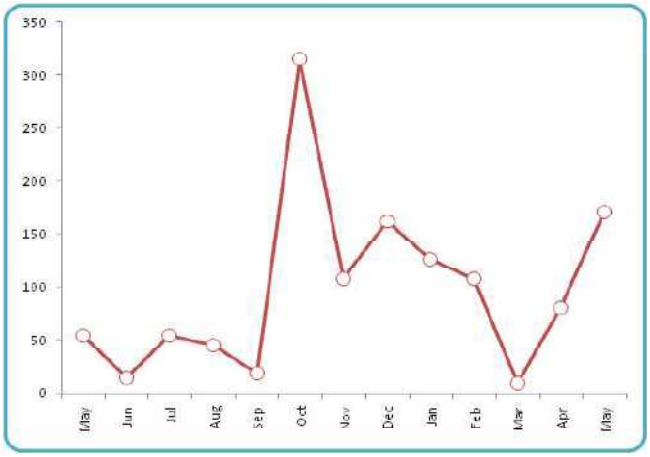


Fig. 4: The abundance of zooplankton population with respect to the temperature at Ranchi Lake

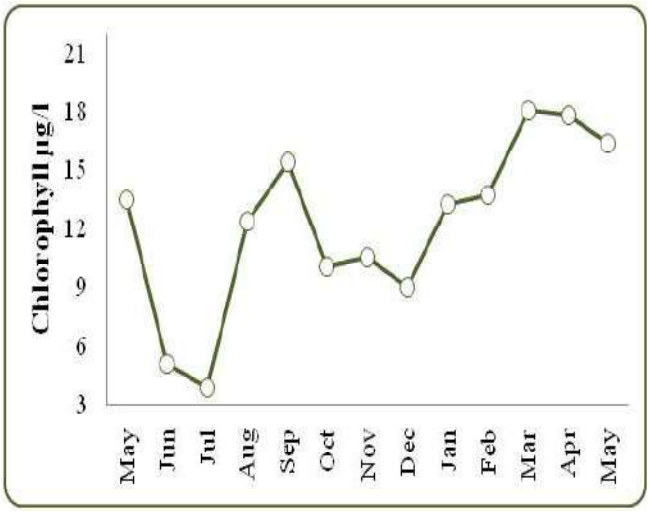


Fig. 5: The abundance of phytoplankton population with respect to the food availability at Ranchi Lake

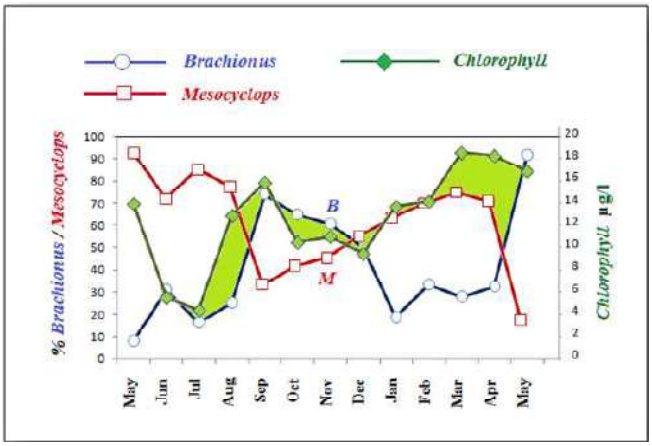


Fig. 6: The fluctuations of *Mesocyclops* and *Brachionus* at Ranchi lake

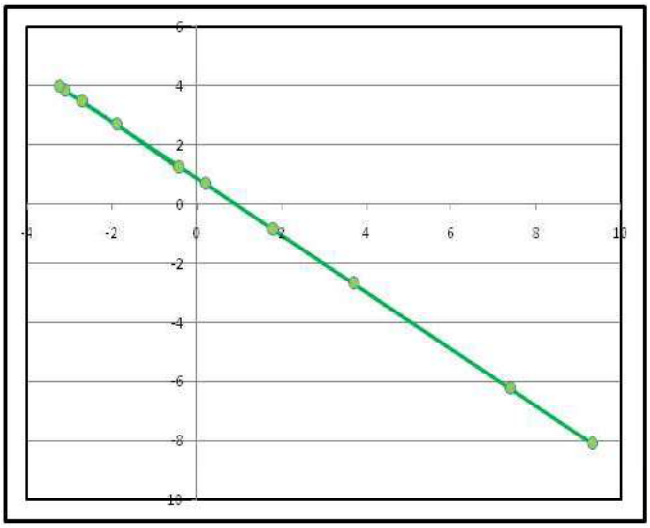


Fig. 7: showing a negative correlation between chlorophyll and dead organic matter

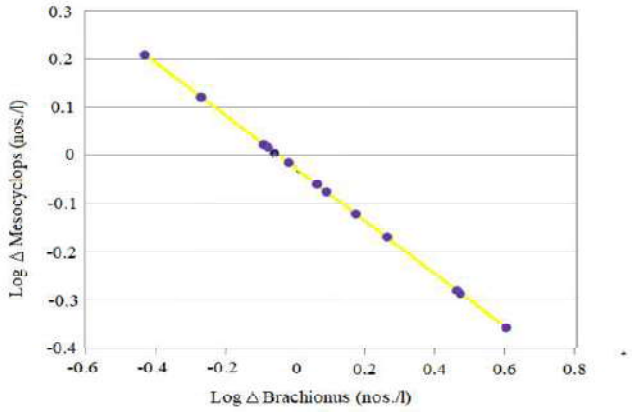


Fig. 8: Double logarithmic plot showing the negative correlation between *Mesocyclops* and *Brachionus*

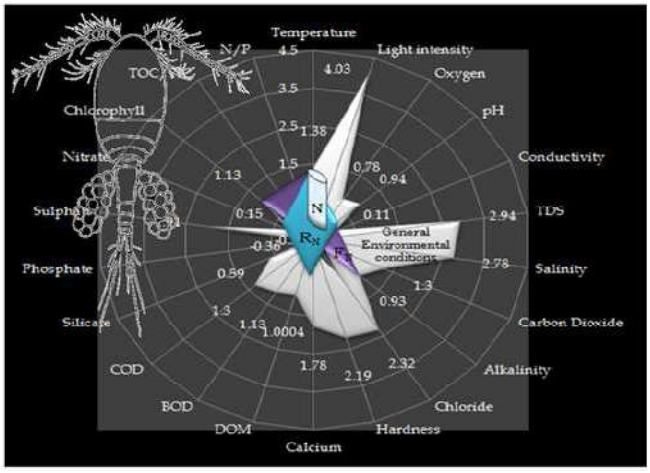


Fig. 9 The general environmental conditions; fundamental niche (FN); Realized niche (RN) and the *Mesocyclops* population (N)

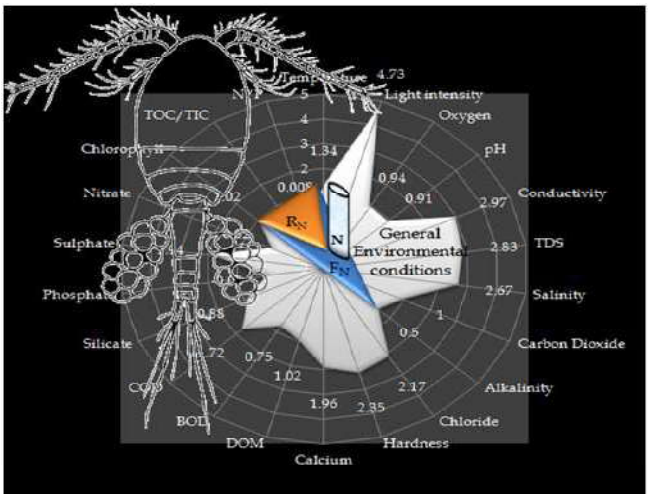


Fig. 10: The general environmental conditions; fundamental niche (FN); Realized niche (RN) and the Mesocyclops population (N) in the month of November

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